

POSTER PRINT CHECKLIST

For Adobe InDesign & Illustrator

DOCUMENT SETUP

- Correct Size: Document matches final poster size (e.g., 24"x36").
- Bleed Added: 0.125" (3 mm) bleed on all sides.
- Safe Margins: Keep important content at least 0.25" from the trim edge.

COLOR & IMAGES

- CMYK Color Mode: File set to CMYK, not RGB.
- High-Resolution Images: All raster images are 300 DPI.
- No Low-Res Images: Avoid images from the web.
- Color Matching: CMYK prints duller than screen (use Pantone if exact match needed).

TEXT & FONTS

- Legible Font Sizes: Headline, subhead, and body text readable from a distance.
- Correct Black Use:
 - Body text: Plain black (C:0 M:0 Y:0 K:100)
 - Large areas: Rich black (C:60 M:40 Y:40 K:100)
- Fonts Embedded or Outlined:
 - Illustrator: Type > Create Outlines
 - InDesign: Export to PDF with fonts embedded.

LINKS & FILES

- No Missing Links: All images linked, not missing (check Links panel).
- Packaged File (InDesign): File > Package to collect fonts and images if sending source files.

EXPORT FOR PRINT

- Export as PDF: PDF/X-1a or Press Quality.
- Include Bleeds and Crop Marks:
 - InDesign: File > Export > Adobe PDF (Print) > Marks and Bleeds
 - Check Use Document Bleed Settings and Crop Marks
- Transparency Flattened (for Illustrator if needed).

FINAL CHECK

- Run Preflight (InDesign): No missing fonts, links, or overset text.

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- Test Print: Optional - print at home/school to check layout and readability.
- Visual Check: Balanced layout, strong type hierarchy, good contrast.